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Subject - E-Commerce & ERP

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1. E-Commerce or Electronic Commerce refers to the buying and selling of goods, services, and information using electronic networks, mainly the internet. It includes online transactions, digital payments, electronic data interchange, online marketing, and customer support. E-Commerce reduces geographical barriers, lowers operational costs, and enables businesses to operate 24 x 7.
- E-Commerce Business Models:-
- (a) B2B (Business to Business) → In this model, transactions occur between two businesses. Examples include manufacturers selling to wholesalers or suppliers selling raw materials to industries. Eg:- Alibaba, In dia MART.
- Employment Impact - Creates jobs in supply chain management, ERP handling, sales coordination, and IT support.
- (b) B2C (Business to Consumer) → Businesses sell products or services directly to customers through online platforms.
- Eg:- Amazon, Flipkart.
- Employment Impact - Generates employment in logistics, customer service, digital marketing, web development, and warehouse operations.
- (c) C2C (Consumer to Consumer) → Consumers sell goods or services directly to other consumers using online platforms.
- Eg:- OLX, eBay.
- ~~Self~~ Employment Impact - Encourages individuals to become independent sellers or resellers.
- (d) C2B (Consumer to Business) → Individuals offer products or services to businesses. Eg:- Freelancing platforms like Fiverr, Upwork.

Employment Impact - Enables freelancers, content creators, and consultants to earn independently.

2.

ERP (Enterprise Resource Planning) is an integrated software system used to manage and automate core business processes such as finance, HR, manufacturing, sales, and supply chain within an organization.

The basic concepts of ERP are:-

- Centralized database
- Real-time data processing
- Integrated business functions
- Standardized workflows
- Improved decision-making.

Architecture of ERP System:-

ERP architecture typically follows a three-tier structure:-

- Presentation layer → User interface through which users interact with the system (web or desktop).
- Application layer → Contains business logic and functional modules like HR, Finance, SCM.
- Database layer → Stores all organizational data in a centralized database.

The benefits of ERP Integration are:-

- Eliminates data duplication
- Improves operational efficiency
- Enhances coordination between departments
- Provides accurate and timely reports
- Reduces operational costs.

ERP creates career opportunities such as:-

- ERP Consultant
- Functional Analyst
- ERP Developer
- Database Administrator
- System Integrator.

3. ERP systems consist of various functional modules that support different business activities.

i) Finance Module → Manages accounting, budgeting, financial reporting, and auditing.

Job Roles - Financial analyst, ERP finance consultant.

ii) Human Resource (HR) Module → Handles recruitment, payroll, attendance, training, and performance management.

Job Roles - HR executive, HRIS analyst.

iii) Supply Chain Management (SCM) Module → Manages procurement, inventory, production planning, and logistics.

Job Roles - Supply chain analyst, logistics manager.

iv) Customer Relationship Management (CRM) Module → Manages customer data, sales, marketing and customer support.

Job Roles - CRM consultant, sales analyst.

Employability Impact → Knowledge of ERP modules enhances employability by aligning technical skills with real business processes.

4. E-Commerce technologies play a vital role in promoting entrepreneurship and self-employment.

i) Online Payment Systems → Enables secure and instant transactions. Eg:- UPI, Paytm, PayPal.

Benefit - Small entrepreneurs can sell products without physical cash handling.

ii) Digital Marketing → Uses SEO, social media, email marketing, and ads to reach customers globally.

Benefit - Low cost promotion helps startups and freelancers grow their businesses.

iii) E-Marketplaces → Provides ready platforms for selling products. Eg:- Amazon, Flipkart, Meesho.

Benefit - Individuals can start businesses without owning

any physical stores.

These technologies reduce entry barriers, encourage innovation, and enable individuals to become self-reliant entrepreneurs.

5. Integration of E-Commerce with ERP means connecting online sales platforms with internal business systems like inventory, finance, and logistics.

Key Integration Areas are:-

- Online orders automatically update ERP.
- Inventory levels sync in real time.
- Financial data is updated instantly.
- Customer data flows into CRM.

Benefits for Business Growth:-

- Faster order processing.
- Reduced manual errors.
- Better inventory control.
- Improved customer satisfaction.
- Data-driven decision making.

Employment Prospects:-

Creates demand for -

- Integration developers
- ERP specialists.
- Data analysts.
- E-Commerce managers.
- System administrators.